



Annual Report

2023-24



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From Secretary's Desk

Greetings from LOK SWAR,

Since its foundation in 2000, **Lok Swar** has remained steadfast in its commitment to uplifting society's most vulnerable and marginalized communities by acting as a grassroots facilitator and enabler rather than providing mere temporary aid.

Our core philosophy centers on enhancing the socioeconomic standing of these groups by establishing safe, supportive environments where individuals can thrive, learn, and participate fully without restraint. To achieve sustainable self-reliance, we focus on long-term capability building—providing specialized training programs, practical skills, and economic tools that empower families to manage local livelihood opportunities and achieve lasting socio-economic security.

Every initiative we undertake is deeply community-informed, rooted in the lived realities of the people we serve to ensure our interventions are practical, culturally resonant, and grounded in mutual trust. Crucially, we foster inclusive civic participation by empowering women and marginalized families to take active roles in local governance, such as Gram Sabhas, while bridging the gap to essential government schemes so that every community member has a voice in resource allocation and local planning.

Lok Swar is guided by institutional integrity and accountability, Lok Swar maintains strict standards of operational transparency and evidence-based reporting, building trusted, enduring partnerships with local communities, donors, and institutions as we work together toward a more equitable society

Shalini Samvedna
Secretary



LOK SWAR, formed in 2000 by female activists from Dhurwa, had its roots in a prior informal association dedicated to social development, especially women's issues. Officially registered under the Indian Trusts Act 1882, it has since focused on uplifting vulnerable and marginalized communities & section of the society. Its inaugural governing body meeting occurred in 1999, marking its foundational moment. Prior to its establishment, the founders had been involved in various social causes for over a decade. Their collective aim was to create a society devoid of caste, class, exploitation, and injustice, striving to meet everyone's basic needs with dignity.

Mission

To empower vulnerable communities, especially women and girls, by strengthening leadership, rights, self-reliance, and access to inclusive socio-economic opportunities.

Vision

To build an inclusive and empowered society where every person lives with dignity, selfreliance, and sustainable well-being.

Goal

To contribute to resilient and self-reliant communities where women and girl's exercise their rights, participate in decision-making, lead change, and access equal opportunities for a dignified and sustainable life.

At LOK SWAR, we believe that sustainable development begins when communities become active architects of their own future. Guided by the principles of equity, inclusion, and participation, we work alongside vulnerable and marginalised groups to create lasting social change. Our approach combines grassroots mobilisation, capacity building, facilitating access to government schemes and institution strengthening to address the root causes of poverty, inequality, and exclusion.

We recognise that communities possess immense knowledge, resilience, and leadership potential. Therefore, we prioritise local participation, women-led initiatives, and community ownership in every intervention. By fostering partnerships with government institutions, civil society organisations, private sector stakeholders, and development partners, we strive to create enabling ecosystems where individuals and communities can thrive.

Our interventions directly contribute to 8 key United Nations Sustainable Development Goals to empower communities across rural and tribal regions of India.



Year at a Glance

LOK SWAR is in its mission of transforming lives of people which is evident in its numbers. This section showcases the overview of what we as an organization has reached in the FY 2023-2024.



675 Girls Empowered



345 Youth Empowered

50 farmers empowered



346 Women Strengthened

30 PRI members Strengthened



Our Partners:



Our Principles

At Lok Swar, we put vulnerable communities at the center of progress, and women at the helm of leadership.

Born from the lived strength of survivors, our work spans education, livelihoods, skill development, digital inclusion—guided by a simple truth: real change doesn't happen for communities instead it happens with them. When we uplift women as decision-makers, we ignite a ripple effect of justice, resilience, and dignity across every generation.

01

ECOSYSTEM STRENGTHENING & COMMUNITY WELL-BEING

We work alongside local networks to establish safe, supportive environments where vulnerable communities can thrive, learn, and participate fully without any restraint.

02

SUSTAINABLE SELF-RELIANCE

We focus on capability building rather than temporary aid. By providing targeted training, practical skills, and economic tools, we enable communities to create sustainable livelihoods and guide their families towards socio-economic security.

03

COMMUNITY-INFORMED PRACTICE

Our initiatives are informed by the lived realities of the communities we serve. This ground-level insight ensures our programs are practical, culturally resonant, and built on deep local trust.

04

INCLUSIVE CIVIC PARTICIPATION

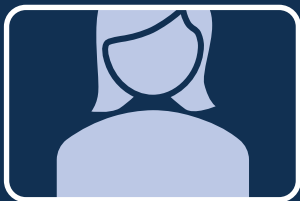
We facilitate active participation for women in local governance and community forums, including Gram Sabhas, ensuring marginalized families have a meaningful say in local planning and resource allocation.

05

INSTITUTIONAL INTEGRITY & ACCOUNTABILITY

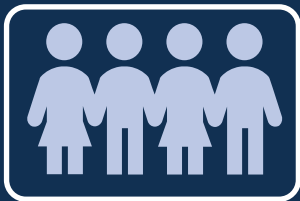
We maintain clear standards of operational transparency, evidence-based reporting, and responsible stewardship to build trusted partnerships with communities, donors, and institutions.

Our Thematic Focus



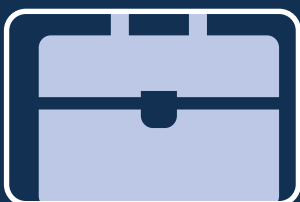
Empowering Woman and Gender Equality

We work to enhance women's agency, leadership, economic independence, and participation in decision-making processes at the household, community, and institutional levels.



Child Empowerment and Youth Development

We work to promote quality education, child protection, life skills, and meaningful participation of children in matters affecting their lives.



Sustainable Livelihood and Entrepreneurship

We work with vulnerable households in strengthening livelihoods through farm, non-farm, off-farm models, diversifying income sources, and building resilient local enterprises that improve economic security and self-reliance.



Community Development

We work towards the overall improvement of the community by promoting safe migration & Anti-trafficking, strengthening healthcare ecosystems, and facilitating the access to social protection and entitlements.



Digital Literacy & Skill Development

We work towards bridging the gap between the vulnerable communities and real world by improving their capabilities and capacities through digital literacy and skill development programs.



Access to Government Welfare Schemes

We help vulnerable households access government welfare schemes, essential services, and social protection benefits.



Research, Advocacy & Capacity Building

We conduct research, generate knowledge, strengthen institutions, and advocate for policies that promote equity, inclusion, and community well-being.

LOK SWAR has remained dedicated to empowering female across age groups in Jharkhand. Through strategic partnerships with donors like the British Asian Trust, Connect HeR, Girls First Fund and self-supported programs we have addressed critical intersections of themes across communities. For the empowerment of females from various age groups, LOK SWAR has been dedicatedly working across districts in Jharkhand state.

Project Name: Promote Safe Mobility and Counter Trafficking

Donor: British Asian Trust

Thematic Area: Community Development

Location: Namkum



Project Brief: The Promotion of Safe Mobility and Counter Trafficking project is a comprehensive intervention designed to protect vulnerable, mobile populations from human trafficking, forced labor, and exploitation while safeguarding their right to free, informed movement. By addressing these critical vulnerabilities across high-migration corridors and transit hubs, the initiative focuses on empowering community members—particularly women, youth, and migrant workers—with essential rights awareness, safe migration protocols, and digital safety tools. Through the monthly thematic workshops, multi-stakeholder strategy dialogues with border control, transport unions, and transit authorities, and structured peer-learning exposure visits, the project strengthens localized protection networks and drives systemic advocacy. Ultimately, this multi-sectoral strategy establishes robust early-warning mechanisms, equips frontline actors to intercept trafficking attempts, and fosters institutional cross-border collaboration to ensure migration remains safe, legal, and dignified.



Major Activities:

- **Capacity Building & Safety Workshops:** Conducted monthly interactive workshops focusing on safe migration protocols, counter-trafficking awareness, legal rights, and physical and digital safety tools for at-risk mobile populations.
- **Community Mobilization & Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):** Facilitated targeted FGDs and community meetings to identify local vulnerability drivers, gather ground-level insights, and foster grassroots anti-trafficking vigilance networks.
- **Awareness Campaigns & Information Drives:** Organized widespread awareness initiatives across key migration transit hubs, using local media, information kiosks, and community events to educate vulnerable groups on safe mobility practices and early warning indicators of trafficking.
- **Social Security Scheme Convergence:** Actively linked mobile workers and vulnerable families to government welfare programs, facilitating enrollment in health coverage, formal employment schemes, life/accident insurance, and social safety nets to build economic resilience against exploitation.

- **Multi-Stakeholder Meetings & Institutional Dialogue:** Hosted regular coordination meetings with transit authorities, law enforcement, border officials, civil society groups, and local governance bodies to build integrated protection pathways and enforce counter-trafficking policies.

Project Name: Preventing and Responding to Child Marriage and Early Unions

Donor: Girls First Fund (USA)

Thematic Area: Child Empowerment and Youth Development

Location: Khunti



Project Brief: Child, Early, and Forced Marriage and Unions represent a profound violation of human rights that disproportionately impacts adolescent girls. It is rooted in deep-seated patriarchal norms, economic hardship, systemic gender inequality, and gaps in formal education. It deprives young individuals of their fundamental bodily autonomy, safety, and future potential.

While multi-sectoral support is necessary for those already impacted, prevention is the primary path to ending it by stopping early unions before they occur breaks the cycle of intergenerational poverty, reduces maternal health complications, and keeps girls in school. This executive summary outlines a multi-layered preventative strategy designed to eliminate the root drivers of child marriage by empowering adolescent girls, transforming social norms, alleviating economic pressures, and reinforcing protective legal systems.

Major Activities:

- **Capacity Building & Leadership Workshops:** Conducted monthly, theme-based interactive workshops focused on youth leadership development, child marriage (CM) prevention, domestic violence (DV) awareness, and fundamental rights.
- **Community Mobilization & Stakeholder Dialogue:** Facilitated Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), multi-stakeholder strategy meetings, and specialized training sessions to drive localized advocacy and shift social norms.
- **Experiential Learning & Field Exposure:** Organized structured exposure visits and peer-learning tours to exchange best practices, strengthen networks, and observe successful intervention models in action.



Project Name: Leadership Development of Mother's Football Team through Sports

Donor: Connect HeR

Thematic Area: Empowering Woman and Gender Equality

Location: Khunti



Project Brief: The Leadership Development of Mother's Football Team through Sports initiative leverages the power of athletics to transform mothers from primary domestic caregivers into empowered community leaders, decision-makers, and advocates. In many communities, mothers face social isolation, limited personal agency, and restricted access to health and leadership opportunities.

By taking mothers onto the football pitch, this project breaks gender stereotypes, improves physical and mental well-being, and uses sports-based experiential learning to build critical soft skills—including teamwork, strategic thinking, negotiation, and public speaking. The program creates a safe, vibrant platform where mothers gain the confidence and agency to lead both within their households and across their local communities.

Major Activities:

- **Football Training & Physical Fitness Clinics:** Conducted regular, structured football sessions to promote physical health, build teamwork, and cultivate resilience as an experiential entry point for leadership development.
- **Capacity Building & Leadership Workshops:** Hosted monthly, interactive workshops leveraging sports to build soft skills—such as communication, negotiation, and strategic thinking—with a core focus on rights awareness, bodily autonomy, and combating Gender-Based Violence (GBV).
- **Community Dialogue & FGD Meetings:** Facilitated Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) and community meetings to create safe spaces for sharing experiences, identifying local GBV risks, and developing collective community action plans.
- **Experiential Learning & Field Exposure Visits:** Organized cross-learning exposure tours to interact with peer teams, survivor support centers, and women-led community initiatives to exchange best practices and strengthen protection networks.
- **Awareness Campaigns & Community Showcase Matches:** Hosted exhibition matches and local tournaments coupled with GBV awareness drives to engage community members, challenge restrictive gender norms, and position women as visible champions for safety and change.



At Lok Swar, our commitment to grassroots social change extends beyond the timelines and scopes of donor-funded projects. Recognizing that community needs require continuous engagement, Lok Swar actively designs and executes Self-Supported Programs driven by local ownership, volunteerism, and direct community resource pooling.



While donor-funded projects allow us to scale specific structured interventions, our self-supported initiatives reflect our core philosophy: empowering communities to become self-reliant drivers of their own development.

Programme Name: 1-Day Awareness Workshop on Climate Change

Thematic Area: Community Development

Location: Khunti

Workshop Brief: The 1-Day Awareness Workshop on Climate Change is a targeted, action-oriented capacity-building initiative designed to equip local governance representatives, community leaders, and grassroots stakeholders with the knowledge and tools required to build climate resilience. As rural and semi-urban communities face increasing threats from shifting weather patterns, water scarcity, and extreme climate events, local governance bodies—specifically Gram Panchayats—play a frontline role in climate mitigation and adaptation.

This workshop bridges the gap between high-level climate science and actionable local governance. By translating climate risks into practical planning tools, the program empowers participants to embed climate-resilient strategies directly into village-level development frameworks.

Key Workshop Components & Modules

- **Module 1: Understanding Climate Change:** Demystifying climate science by connecting global environmental trends to localized impacts—such as shifting rainfall patterns, agricultural instability, heatwaves, and water stress.
- **Module 2: Climate Change & Risk Mapping:** Conducting interactive, participatory mapping exercises to identify vulnerable geography, community assets, and at-risk populations within the local Panchayat.
- **Module 3: Integrating Climate Concerns into GPDP & Local Priorities:** Guiding local representatives on how to embed climate-resilient schemes (water conservation, sustainable agriculture, green infrastructure, and disaster readiness) directly into the official Gram Panchayat Development Plan (GPDP).

Programme Name: Sensitization Workshop for Strengthening PRI Members and Elected Representatives

Thematic Area: Research, Advocacy and Capacity Building

Location: Khunti

Workshop Brief: The Sensitization Workshop for Strengthening Panchayati Raj Institution (PRI) Members and Elected Representatives is a strategic capacity-building initiative designed to empower

local self-governance leaders with the knowledge, skills, and ethical orientation required for inclusive, transparent, and effective grassroots governance. As the closest tier of government to citizens, PRI members—especially newly elected leaders and women representatives—play a decisive role in driving socio-economic development, protecting human rights, and ensuring social justice.

This workshop focuses on demystifying local governance roles, enhancing leadership capabilities, and building institutional capacity to ensure that public services, social protection schemes, and local development funds effectively reach marginalized communities.



Key Workshop Components & Modules

- Module 1: Constitutional Roles, Mandates & Governance Systems: Clarifying the legal powers, administrative functions, committee structures, and statutory duties of Ward Members, Sarpanches/Pradhans, and Panchayat Secretaries.
- Module 2: Inclusive Development, Gender & Social Justice: Sensitizing representatives on gender-transformative leadership, preventing gender-based violence (GBV) and child marriage, and prioritizing marginalized households in welfare distribution.
- Module 3: Participatory GPDP & Resource Optimization: Training leaders on how to mobilize local revenue, utilize central/state finance grants, and lead participatory planning during Gram Sabhas.
- Module 4: Transparency, Accountability & Citizen Rights: Strengthening democratic oversight through Social Audits, the Right to Information (RTI), public displays, and digital governance tools.

Programme Name: 1 Day Training on Identifying Sustainable Livelihood Opportunities

Thematic Area: Research, Advocacy and Capacity Building Sub Theme: Sustainable Livelihood and Entrepreneurship

Location: Khunti

Workshop Brief: The 1-Day Training on Identifying Sustainable Livelihood Opportunities is a practical, capacity-building initiative designed to empower rural households—with an emphasis on women and youth—

to build resilient, diversified, and climate-smart income sources. In vulnerable rural ecosystems, relying on a single, weather-dependent income stream leaves households highly susceptible to economic and environmental shocks.

This training bridges local resource availability with market realities. By guiding participants through resource mapping, market demand assessment, financial planning, value addition, and community safety nets like Grain Banks, the workshop equips rural communities with the skills to establish low-risk, viable micro-enterprises and achieve long-term economic independence.

Key Training Modules

- **Module 1: Foundations of Sustainable Livelihoods & Diversification**
 - ✓ Understanding Sustainable Livelihoods: Defining eco-friendly, durable, and resilient livelihood models that survive environmental and economic stresses.
 - ✓ Income Diversification: Strategies to supplement traditional seasonal farming with multiple year-round income streams to mitigate household risk.
- **Module 2: Local Resource Mapping & Market Intelligence**
 - ✓ Mapping Skills & Resources: Conducting participatory exercises to inventory local natural assets, raw materials, traditional skills, and untapped opportunities.
 - ✓ Understanding Local Market Demand: Identifying market gaps, consumer needs, pricing trends, and viable sales channels within nearby rural and peri-urban markets.
- **Module 3: Enterprise Building, Value Addition & Climate Resilience**
 - ✓ Women & Youth-Led Enterprises: Supporting self-help groups (SHGs) and youth collectives to start and manage collective micro-enterprises.
 - ✓ Value Addition & Food Processing: Techniques for primary processing, packaging, and refining local produce (e.g., spices, grains, forest produce) to fetch higher market margins.
 - ✓ Climate-Resilient & Low-Risk Options: Exploring eco-friendly agriculture, non-farm trades, poultry, goatry, and organic input production.
- **Module 4: Financial Literacy, Government Linkages & Action Planning**
 - ✓ Cost, Investment, Profit & Risk Assessment: Basic financial modeling—calculating initial capital requirements, operating costs, profit margins, and risk management.
 - ✓ Scheme & Credit Access: Navigating government welfare programs, subsidised loans, bank credit linkages, and official skill development initiatives.
 - ✓ Developing a Practical Livelihood Action Plan: Facilitating participants to draft individualized, step-by-step household income generation plans.



Shanti a young woman from a small village in Khunti, felt her economic options were limited to seasonal daily labor. Like many women in her community, she lacked the technical knowledge to identify or start a sustainable business that could provide a year-round income for her family.

Shanti participated in a one-day intensive workshop organized by LOK SWAR. The program focused on:

- **Identifying Options:** Mapping out sustainable livelihood paths available within the local economy.
- **Resource Mapping:** Understanding how to access the tools and networks needed to start a small-scale venture.
- **Action Planning:** Developing a basic roadmap for financial independence.

Shanti has since begun organizing a small collective to explore sustainable non-timber forest products.

"I always had the will to work, but I didn't have the map," Shanti says. "One day of training showed me that my skills have value beyond the fields. I am finally building a future that belongs to me, not just one I have to settle for".

Programme Name: 1 Day Workshop of Women and Girls on Reproductive Health

Thematic Area: Research, Advocacy and Capacity Building

Location: Khunti

Workshop Brief: The 1-Day Workshop for Women and Girls on Reproductive Health is an empowering, health-centered capacity-building initiative designed to break social stigmas, foster bodily autonomy, and promote health equity across generations. In many rural and semi-urban communities, reproductive and sexual health topics remain shrouded in silence, leading to widespread misinformation, poor hygiene practices, nutritional deficiencies, and unaddressed health complications.

This workshop creates a safe, culturally sensitive, and supportive environment where adolescent girls, young women, and mothers can access medically accurate information. By connecting reproductive biology, menstrual hygiene, balanced nutrition, and adolescent wellness, the program equips participants with the knowledge and confidence required to make informed healthcare choices and lead healthier, dignified lives.

Key Training Modules & Components

Module 1: Understanding Reproductive Health

- ✓ Female Anatomy & Physiology: Basic, accessible orientation on the female reproductive system, hormonal cycles, and bodily functions.
- ✓ Demystifying Taboos & Myths: Addressing common cultural misconceptions, fears, and stigmas associated with female health and bodily changes.
- ✓ Preventive Healthcare & Care-Seeking: Recognizing symptoms of common infections (e.g., UTIs, RTIs),
- ✓ understanding cervical and breast health, and encouraging timely visits to local health centers.

Module 2: Menstrual Health & Hygiene (MHM)

- ✓ Biological Understanding: Explaining the science of the menstrual cycle in simple, relatable terms.
- ✓ Safe Hygiene Practices: Proper selection, usage, cleaning, and disposal of absorbents (sanitary pads, reusable cloth pads, cups).
- ✓ Pain Management & Self-Care: Safe techniques for managing menstrual cramps and understanding when to seek medical advice for irregular cycles.

Module 3: Nutrition & Reproductive Health

- ✓ Gender & Nutritional Disparities: Highlighting the critical need for adequate nutrition for women and girls within the household.
- ✓ Combating Anemia & Iron Deficiency: Identifying iron-rich local foods, understanding iron-folic acid (IFA) supplementation, and recognizing anemia symptoms.
- ✓ Life-Stage Nutrition: Tailored dietary guidelines covering adolescence, menstruation, pregnancy, and lactation.

Module 4: Adolescent Sexual & Reproductive Health (SRHR)

- ✓ Navigating Puberty: Guiding adolescent girls through physical, emotional, and psychological changes during puberty.
- ✓ Rights, Boundaries & Consent: Building awareness around bodily autonomy, personal safety, good touch/bad touch, and age-appropriate rights.
- ✓ Preventing Early Pregnancy: Educating on the severe physical and developmental risks associated with child marriage and early unions.

In many villages of Khunti, adolescent boys and girls lacked access to scientific information regarding Reproductive and Sexual Health (SRHR). Misconceptions and cultural taboos often left youth vulnerable to health risks and social pressures.

As part of the LOK SWAR self-supported program, a comprehensive one-day sensitization workshop was held for children in the community. The session used age-appropriate focus group discussions (FGDs) to explain reproductive health, consent, and bodily autonomy. The workshop reached 300 direct participants, significantly increasing their awareness of SRHR. Shweta, one of the attendees, now helps facilitate discussions among his peers to dispel common myths.

"I realized that being 'grown up' means having the right information to make safe choices," Shweta reflects. "The workshop gave us a space to ask questions we were too afraid to ask at home. Now, we understand our bodies and our rights much better."



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Contact Person	Mrs. Shalini Samvedna (Secretary)
Legal Status	Registered Under Indian Trust Act 1882, Regsitration No -8126, 12A
Date Of Registration	3 rd August 2000
Yearof Registration under FCRA	2004, Renewal completed in 2016 & 2021
FCRA No	337800123
PAN	AAATL3536E
TAN	RCHL00419G
12A	AATL3536EE20214
80G	AATL3536EF20221
Governing Body	Consists of 8 members (3 males) & (5 Females)

Shalini Samvedna

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